

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Title: Jenkins SSH Known Hosts Configuration

Version: 1.0

Last Updated: 15-Feb-2026

Purpose

To ensure secure and successful SSH connectivity from Jenkins to remote servers by properly configuring the `known_hosts` file for the Jenkins user.

Scope

This SOP applies to Jenkins CI/CD pipelines requiring SSH access to remote servers such as EC2, virtual machines, or on-prem systems.

Problem Statement

Jenkins fails to establish SSH connection due to missing `known_hosts` file, resulting in host key verification failure.

Procedure

- Switch to Jenkins user.
- Ensure `.ssh` directory exists with proper permissions.
- Create `known_hosts` file.
- Add remote server fingerprint using `ssh-keyscan`.
- Verify permissions and test SSH connectivity.

Security Guidelines

- Keep `StrictHostKeyChecking` enabled.
- Use key-based SSH authentication only.
- Avoid root login for Jenkins.
- Rotate SSH keys periodically.

Approval

Role	Name	Signature
DevOps Lead		
Project Manager		